DESCRIPTION, STRUCTURE AND CONTENT OF MARITIME GOVERNANCE MODULAR COURSE

DESCRIPTION OF PROGRAMME

Rationale

For decades, the African continent has faced a wide range of maritime security threats and challenges, none of which can be fully addressed without strategic guidance. Consequently, the continent witnessed a proliferation of strategy documents, including the 2050 Africa's Integrated Maritime Strategy in 2012, the Lomé Charter in 2016, and the Africa Blue Economy Strategy in 2019. At the regional level, we have the Yaoundé Architecture for Maritime Security (YAMS), the ECOWAS Integrated Maritime Strategy among others. At the national level, some African states also began processes toward developing comprehensive maritime strategies. Whether or not these strategies are on course to achieve their intended objectives remains debatable. With a growing recognition amongst African states of the importance of the continent's vast maritime domain comes a responsibility to ensure its protection at all levels. Effective maritime security strategies could provide a unique framework for attaining this. What remains crucial, is to ground relevant maritime practitioners and policymakers in the theoretical and practical underpinnings necessary to develop purposeful, targeted maritime strategies or to successfully implement existing ones in national and regional contexts. This course is intended to provide such grounding. By exposing participants to key principles and best practices for developing and implementing maritime strategies, the programme will expand the expertise necessary to ensure that African states have the skills they truly need to address their peculiar mix of maritime threats and challenges.

Goals/Objectives

The goal of the Maritime Governance Course is to equip professionals, stakeholders, and decision-makers with the knowledge, skills, and tools necessary to understand the maritime strategy development and implementation process within the African context. Specifically, the course will achieve the following objectives:

- Understand how maritime strategy enhances both national and regional priorities and objectives.
- Generate an understanding of how to develop maritime strategies that address Africa's unique challenges.
- Examine the primary features that enhance the sustainability of strategies and action plans or otherwise;
- Explore tools and techniques that can facilitate the implementation of continental, regional and national maritime strategy documents.
- Equip participants with the skill sets necessary to contribute meaningfully to maritime strategy development processes across Africa.
- Explicate the implications of strategy development processes on the success or failure of national, regional and continental strategies.
- Develop the skills of participants to collaborate with stakeholders and partners toward maritime strategy development and implementation.

Target Groups/ Entry Requirements

The course is open to all interested actors within the maritime domain or with a shared interest and may include but not limited to Government Agencies, Non-Governmental Organisations, Private Sectors, Industries, Institutions, Students, and the General Public. The course will be administered virtually and interested participants must have access to the following tools/equipment:

- Reliable internet connection with a minimum recommended bandwidth of 100 Mbps.
- A computer, laptop, or tablet with audio and video capabilities.
- Compatible web browser(s) and any additional software required for the online platform.

Expected Outcomes

- Develop a team of skilled actors to enhance maritime security strategy development processes across the continent.
- Enhance the implementation of existing continental, regional and national strategies in Africa.
- Foster more effective inter-agency and non-governmental organisations coordination toward the implementation of maritime security strategies.
- Enhance networking opportunities and collaboration among participating stakeholders involved in maritime security across Africa.

Format and Methodology/ Mode of Delivery

Live/Virtual (Zoom) Sessions:

The Maritime Governance Course is practically designed to use an interactive learning platform to engage participants. A Zoom online platform will be mounted to provide an interactive and engaging learning experience. Participants will be engaged in a myriad of activities such as interactive simulations, presentations, group discussions, forums and assignments. The course facilitators will use various engagement techniques such as polls, breakout rooms for group activities, whiteboard sharing, and screen sharing for presentations, in the delivery of the course modules. Participants have an avenue to communicate with instructors or peers and seek support where necessary through emails, live chat sessions, and dedicated questions and answers (Q&A) forums. Each course session will be recorded to allow participants to review the content later.

Modular Sessions:

The course content has been categorized into eight (8) modules to be covered over four (4) weeks, with each module covering a specific topic or concept. The course comprises: an introductory session on the outlook of the course; technical presentations and discussions on various concepts related to strategy development; practical case studies; and a final session on key takeaways and information on further learning opportunities. Instructors may share supplementary materials, such as further readings, links to online resources or recorded sessions, to enhance the participants' understanding of each topic.

Attendance: Participant attendance to each of the course sessions is mandatory. However, in case of inability to attend any of the sessions, participants are requested to submit a “request for absence” letter to info@gogmi.org.gh.

STRUCTURE OF PROGRAMME

WEEKS/ DATES	Modules/Units	Facilitators	Contact hours (credit)	
Week 1 - Tuesday, 5th May 2026	**1: Introductions & Maritime Strategy Theory**			
			Presentations	**Practical**
Part I 11:00 – 11:40	**1.1** Welcome and Course Overview: Introduce the purpose, structure, and expected outcomes of the course.	Lawrence Dogli and Prof. Jeffrey Landsman (ret), CAPT, USN (ret)		**10mins**
	1.2 Participants introduction: Foster familiarity and encourage networking among participants.	Lawrence Dogli		**10mins**
	1.3 LMS Onboarding: Guide participants in navigating the Learning Management System (LMS) for accessing course materials and assignments.	Enoch Nikoi		**10mins**
	Q & A Session			**10mins**
Part II 12:00 – 16:10				
	1.4 Strategy Development Directives and Instruments	Dr. Alberta Ama Sagoe, GoGMI		**60mins**
	1.5 Purpose and the need to develop Maritime Strategies	Prof. Jeffrey Landsman (ret), CAPT, USN (ret)		**60mins**
	1.6 Overview of the Strategy Development Process	Prof Jeffrey Landsman (ret), CAPT, USN (ret)		**60mins**
	1.7 Introduction to Maritime Domain & Maritime Sector Reform	Prof Jeffrey Landsman (ret), CAPT, USN (ret)		**60mins**
Week 1 – Thursday, 7th May 2026	**2: Assessing Maritime Domain Challenges & Opportunities**			

12:00-14:35				
	2.1 Preliminary Assessment Process	Prof Jeffrey Landsman (ret), CAPT, USN (ret)		**60mins**
	2.2 SWOT Assessment Tool & Maritime Sector Reform	Prof Jeffrey Landsman (ret), CAPT, USN (ret)		**60mins**
	2.3 Group Discussions/SWOT Activity	Lawrence Dogli & Juliet Afrah Obeng		**30mins**
Week 2 – Tuesday, 12th May 2026 **12:00 – 13:25**	**3: Strategy Development Process**			
	3.1 Developing the Vision Statement	Prof Jeffrey Landsman (ret), CAPT, USN (ret)		**60mins**
Week 2 – Wednesday, 13th May 2026 **12:00-14:05**	**4; Interagency Coordination and Stakeholder Analysis I**			
	4.1 Understanding the role of actors/ stakeholders in maritime strategy development and implementation	Naval Captain Ebenezer Kwame Yirenkyi		**60mins**
	4.2 Understanding how agencies typically align within the maritime sector/domain	Naval Captain Ebenezer Kwame Yirenkyi		**60mins**
Week 2 – Thursday, 14th May 2026 **12:00-15:00**	**5: Interagency Coordination and Stakeholder Analysis II**			
	5.1 Understanding the importance and challenges of interagency coordination within the maritime sector	Lieutenant Commander Kofi Amponsah Duodu (GoGMI)		**60mins**
	5.2 Stakeholder analysis & best practices	Prof Jeffrey Landsman (ret), CAPT, USN (ret)		**60mins**

Week 3 – Tuesday, 19th May 2026 **12:00-13:00**	**6: Ends, Ways, Means, and Risk**			
	6.1 Introduction to Ends, Ways, Means, and Risk	Prof Jeffrey Landsman (ret), CAPT, USN (ret)	**60mins**	
Week 3 – Thursday, 21st May 2026 **12:00-14:00**	**7: Maritime Strategy Implementation**			
	7.1 The Successes and Failures of maritime strategy implementation / Overcoming the lack of strategy implementation and what are the possible mitigation strategies	Vice Admiral Issah Adam Yakubu (ret)		**60mins**
	7.2 Maritime Sector Planning Process - Course of Action Development. Case Study Group Activity Introduction and Assignments	Prof Jeffrey Landsman (ret), CAPT, USN (ret)		**60mins**
Week 4 – Tuesday, 26 May 2026	**7.3** Maritime Strategy Sector Planning - In Class Exercise	Prof Jeffrey Landsman (ret), CAPT, USN (ret)		**120 mins**
Week 4 – Thursday, 28th May 2026, **12:00-14:20**	**8: Case Study Group Report and Course Conclusion**			
	8.1 Groups Present Course of Action Development Justification	Prof Jeffrey Landsman (ret), CAPT, USN (ret) and GoGMI Supporting Staff		**60mins**
	8.2 Course Conclusion and Discussion	Prof Jeffrey Landsman (ret), CAPT, USN (ret)		**60mins**
	8.3 Evaluation of Course	Ms. Juliet Afrah Obeng		**20mins**

CONTENT OF THE PROGRAM

Module 1 (Part I) & II): Maritime Strategy Theory	
Facilitators	❖ **Prof Jeffrey Landsman (ret), CAPT, USN (ret)** ❖ **Dr Alberta Ama Sagoe (GoGMI)** ❖
Description	This module presents an introduction to maritime strategies and the relevance of such strategies to fostering resilience of coastal states against maritime crimes (piracy, overfishing and smuggling) and territorial defence. It explores the goal, key concepts, and recognitional, procedural, contextual, and distributional dimensions in setting up maritime strategic framework. This module also provides insight into existing frameworks and connection to organisational strategies.
Session Objectives	- Understand how the maritime strategy enhances both national and regional priorities and objectives. - Understand why maritime strategies are developed and how they align with national and regional priorities. - Understand the various instruments and directives underpinning the development of maritime strategies. - Understand, recognize and apply the procedural steps for maritime strategy development. - Discuss individual and organisational background for how students align with maritime strategy development.
Learning Outcome	- To become more familiar with theories in maritime strategy development that will be mentioned frequently throughout this training. - To explore various tools, processes and frameworks used in relation to the development of maritime strategies. - To recognize existing frameworks and strategies within the maritime space. - To provide key insight of organisational alignment to maritime strategies.
Reading List	• *A Practical Framework for Maritime Strategy Development*, UNODC Handbook, Global Maritime Crimes Program, (pages 4-12)

	• *Making Maritime Strategies Work- A New Taxonomy*, Dr. Ian Ralby, NMIOTC Journal: 2020, (pages 17-21). • *The Process of National Maritime Strategy Development in Africa*, African Centre for Strategic Studies, (pages 1-2)
Module 2 : Assessing Maritime Strategy Challenges & Opportunities (Part I & II)	
Facilitators	ς **Prof Jeffrey Landsman(ret), CAPT, USN (ret)**
Description	This module investigates the dimensions in the application of maritime security strategies, and the barriers and opportunities for their development in institutional alignment. It evaluates key areas, the enabling environment and critical thinking tools for the use of maritime security strategies. It explores institutional orientation to setting the vision statement for maritime security strategy development. Finally, this module explores the use of SWOT analysis in defining the context of strategy development.
Session Objectives	- Understand the importance of maritime domain assessment and how it enhances the strategy development process. - Examine critical thinking tools and understand how these processes align with strategy development. - Understand the importance of the Vision statement as related to strategy development. - Develop a SWOT analysis and Vision Statement.
Learning Outcome	- To provide insight and evaluation into maritime challenges and limitations in the maritime security strategy development - To understand the concept of critical thinking tools and evaluation mechanisms in the maritime security strategy development - To explore the use of SWOT in maritime security strategy development - To easily develop an institutional vision statement that aligns with the strategy development
Reading List	• *"What is SWOT Analysis,"* Forbes Advisor.com (2023) • *A Practical Framework for Maritime Strategy Development*, UNODC Handbook, Global Maritime Crimes Program, (pages 25-29) • *The Process of National Maritime Strategy Development in Africa*, African Centre for Strategic Studies, (pages 2-5)
Module 3: Strategy Development Process	
Facilitator	• **Prof Jeffrey Landsman (ret), CAPT, USN (ret)**

Description	This module examines the end-to-end process of developing integrated maritime strategies that support effective governance and sustainable development of maritime domains. Participants explore the key phases of strategy formulation - from situational assessment and threat/opportunity identification, through vision-setting and objective definition, to option generation, evaluation, selection, and initial alignment with implementation mechanisms.
Session Objectives	– Understand the importance of why and how the maritime strategy development process is structured as a systematic, iterative sequence of phases, including situational assessment, vision/objective setting, option generation, evaluation, selection, and initial alignment with implementation and governance frameworks. – Understand how to conduct critical thinking through the maritime strategy formulation process, applying structured analytical tools – Understand how different phases of the strategy development process enhance maritime governance outcomes, including better alignment with international obligations
Learning Outcomes	• Describe the key phases of the maritime strategy development process and explain how they integrate international maritime frameworks with national and regional governance priorities. • Apply analytical tools to identify maritime threats, opportunities, and strategic options in a structured and evidence-based manner. • Evaluate and select maritime strategies by assessing feasibility, suitability, acceptability, and sustainability, and demonstrate how to align selected strategies with implementation requirements and multi-stakeholder coordination.
Reading List	• *Routledge Handbook of Maritime Security* • *Maritime Strategy and Global Order* • *Maritime Security: An Introduction by Michael McNicholas (practical guide to threats, assessments, and strategy elements in modern contexts):*
Module 4 & 5: Interagency Coordination and Stakeholder Analysis	
Facilitators	❖ **Vice Admiral Issah Yakubu** ❖ **Lieutenant Commander Kofi Amponsah Duodu (GoGMI)** ❖ **Prof Jeffrey Landsman (ret), CAPT, USN (ret)**
Description	This module explores the importance of involving a broad range of maritime stakeholders and coordination mechanisms necessary to enable a "whole system" approach to the strategy development process. It looks at key elements for stakeholder engagements using the bottom-up approach to identify relevant maritime state actors in the strategy development process, integrating scoring with power-influence indicators and critical thinking methods. This module examines studies of best practices in stakeholder inclusion.

Session Objectives	● Understand the importance of why and how actors and stakeholders are engaged in the strategy development process. ● Understand how to conduct critical thinking through the stakeholder analysis process ● Understand how different actors/stakeholders enhance maritime strategy development and implementation ● Understand and discuss both the positive and more challenging aspects of interagency coordination ● Exercise a Stakeholder analysis tool to guide stakeholder identification and prioritization. ● Understand best practices for interagency coordination, and how these can be enabled through Maritime Strategy. ● Develop a Stakeholder Analysis process tailored to nations and systems.
Learning Outcome	- To explore the importance of stakeholder engagement in maritime security strategy development. - To understand the process of developing stakeholder profiles during the development process - To utilize stakeholder analysis tools in building engagement profiles for strategy development. - To review best practices in stakeholder engagement in maritime security strategy development.
Reading List	• *A Practical Framework for Maritime Strategy Development*, UNODC Handbook, Global Maritime Crimes Program, (pages 14-15,44) • *The Process of National Maritime Strategy Development in Africa*, African Centre for Strategic Studies, (pages 6-10)
Module 6: Ends, Ways, Means	
Facilitators	❖ **Prof Jeffrey Landsman (ret), CAPT, USN (ret)**
Description	This module introduces the concept of Ends, Ways, and Means for maritime strategy development. It explores the concept's alignment to national/regional priorities in maritime strategy development. Also, this module establishes the process of integrating the concept into the defined institutional framework and vision.
Session Objectives	● Understand the importance and how to develop Ends, Ways, and Means for maritime strategy development when considering national/regional priorities. ● Develop Ends, Ways and Means to support established Vision Statements.
Learning Outcome	- To understand the concept of Ends, Ways, and Means for maritime strategy development. - To be able to integrate the concept of Ends, Ways, and Means in vision statement and planning development

Reading List	• *A Practical Framework for Maritime Strategy Development*, UNODC Handbook, Global Maritime Crimes Program, (pages 42-44) • *The Process of National Maritime Strategy Development in Africa*, African Centre for Strategic Studies, (pages 2-5) **Other References:** ● *Africa Union 2050 AIM Strategy* ● *AU's Blue Strategy Article* ● *IMO West & Central Africa Strategy* ● *Maritime Strategy in Africa: Strategic Flaws Exposing Africa to vulnerabilities from food insecurity to external domination*
Module 7: Maritime Strategy Implementation	
Facilitators	❖ **Vice Admiral Issah Yakubu** ❖ **Prof Jeffrey Landsman (ret), CAPT, USN (ret)** ❖
Description	This module explores the mechanisms in maritime security strategy implementation and strategies for mainstreaming maritime security strategies into institutional operation strategies. It addresses programs that enhance the implementation of the strategy in institutions. The module investigates the analytical frameworks and tools during the strategy implementation process. It explores potential challenges, bottlenecks and countermeasures that could impede the integration of the maritime security strategy. This also provides strategies for the monitoring and evaluation of the maritime security strategy development process and implementation.
Session Objectives	● Understand the factors that may lead to the success and failure of maritime strategy implementation. ● Understand the ways and considerations when developing an action plan for maritime security strategy implementation. ● Understand and discuss mitigating approaches to enhance maritime strategy implementation ● Understand the requirements for maritime strategy critique session practical exercise.
Outcome	- To understand how to integrate maritime security strategy theories into programs and institutional operations. - To understand the potential challenges, bottlenecks and countermeasures that could impede the integration of the maritime security strategy. - To understand the process and indicators that can support the progress of the strategy development - To understand indicators for monitoring and evaluation of the maritime security strategy development process and implementation
Reading List	• *A Practical Framework for Maritime Strategy Development*, UNODC Handbook, Global Maritime Crimes Program, (pages 22) • *The Process of National Maritime Strategy Development in Africa*, African Centre for Strategic Studies, (pages 10-12)

Module 8: Case Study and Course Conclusion	
Facilitators	ς **Prof Jeffrey Landsman (ret), CAPT, USN (ret)**
Description	This module provides a session for the review and critiquing of cases of existing maritime security strategies. It sets standard metrics for reviewing the strategies.
Session Objectives	- Actively critique an already established national maritime security strategy based on desired national priorities and objectives.
Outcome	- To create awareness of already existing maritime security strategies in the local and regional context - To understand metrics in assessing the strength and weaknesses of existing maritime security strategies
Reading List	**Case Study Handout**